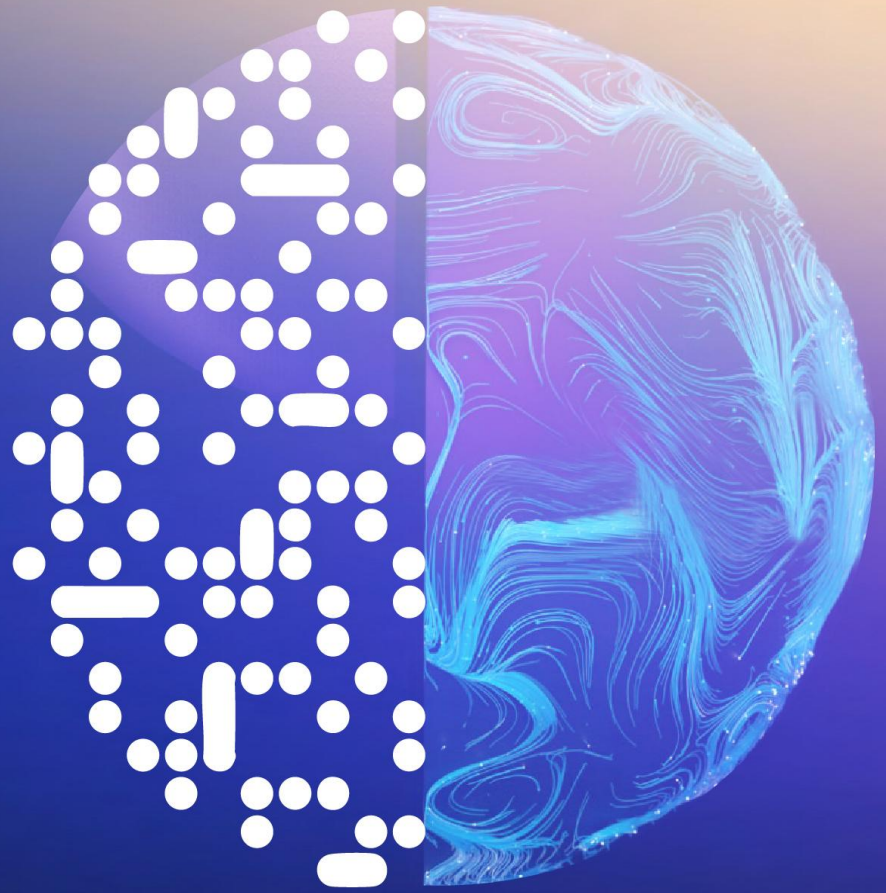
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Track 2 – UAE Hackathon

Pioneers and Rising Stars

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"IF YOU HAVE A POSITIVE OUTLOOK, YOU WILL SEE OPPORTUNITIES IN CHALLENGES, SUCCESS IN THE FUTURE, & IN PEOPLE ENERGIES & TALENTS”

His Highness, Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum



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ABOUT THE UAE HACKATHON



About the UAE Hackathon

The UAE Hackathon is the largest competitive program to promote innovation in the United Arab Emirates.

A National Platform for Collaborative Innovation

UAE Hackathon represents a dynamic national platform that fosters digital community engagement by involving diverse segments of society in designing innovative solutions to national challenges, thus reinforcing the concept of participatory and collaborative innovation.

Transforming Ideas into Solutions for National Challenges

UAE Hackathon attracts students, government employees, entrepreneurs, researchers, and innovators to contribute to developing innovative solutions for challenges facing government entities in the UAE, thereby improving quality of life and enhancing the efficiency of government services.

Driving Innovation Through Open Data

It also encourages participants to leverage open data through the UAE government's open data portal, **Bayanat.ae**, as well as other local data platforms, to develop innovative data-driven solutions.

Strategic Pillars of UAE Hackathon

An integrated innovation ecosystem powered by advanced technologies

Empowering Innovative Minds

Encouraging participants to develop practical, realistic, and sustainable solutions that contribute to improving government services and quality of life.

Integrated Partnerships

Strengthening collaboration between government entities, the private sector, academic institutions, and individuals to ensure alignment of efforts in identifying challenges and designing innovative solutions.

Future-Oriented Direction

Developing challenges aligned with the country's future priorities, focusing on building a proactive and agile government.

Data-Driven Approach

Promoting the use of open data and digital technologies as a foundation for developing innovative, evidence-based solutions.

Empowering Skills and Talents

Organizing workshops and mentorship sessions aimed at enhancing participants' readiness and promoting knowledge and expertise exchange.

Benefits of Participating in the UAE Hackathon

Enhancing Trust

Strengthening transparency and trust in government initiatives and services through community engagement.

Stimulating Innovation

Developing innovative, non-traditional ideas and solutions to address government challenges.

Knowledge Exchange

Promoting the exchange of expertise and gaining insights into government work trends.

Utilizing Talents

Highlighting and leveraging national talents within an innovative environment.

Developing Skills

Enhancing technical and leadership skills and strengthening creative thinking and problem-solving abilities.

Building Relationships

Encouraging the development of professional relationships with government entities, experts, and decision-makers.

Accelerating Solutions

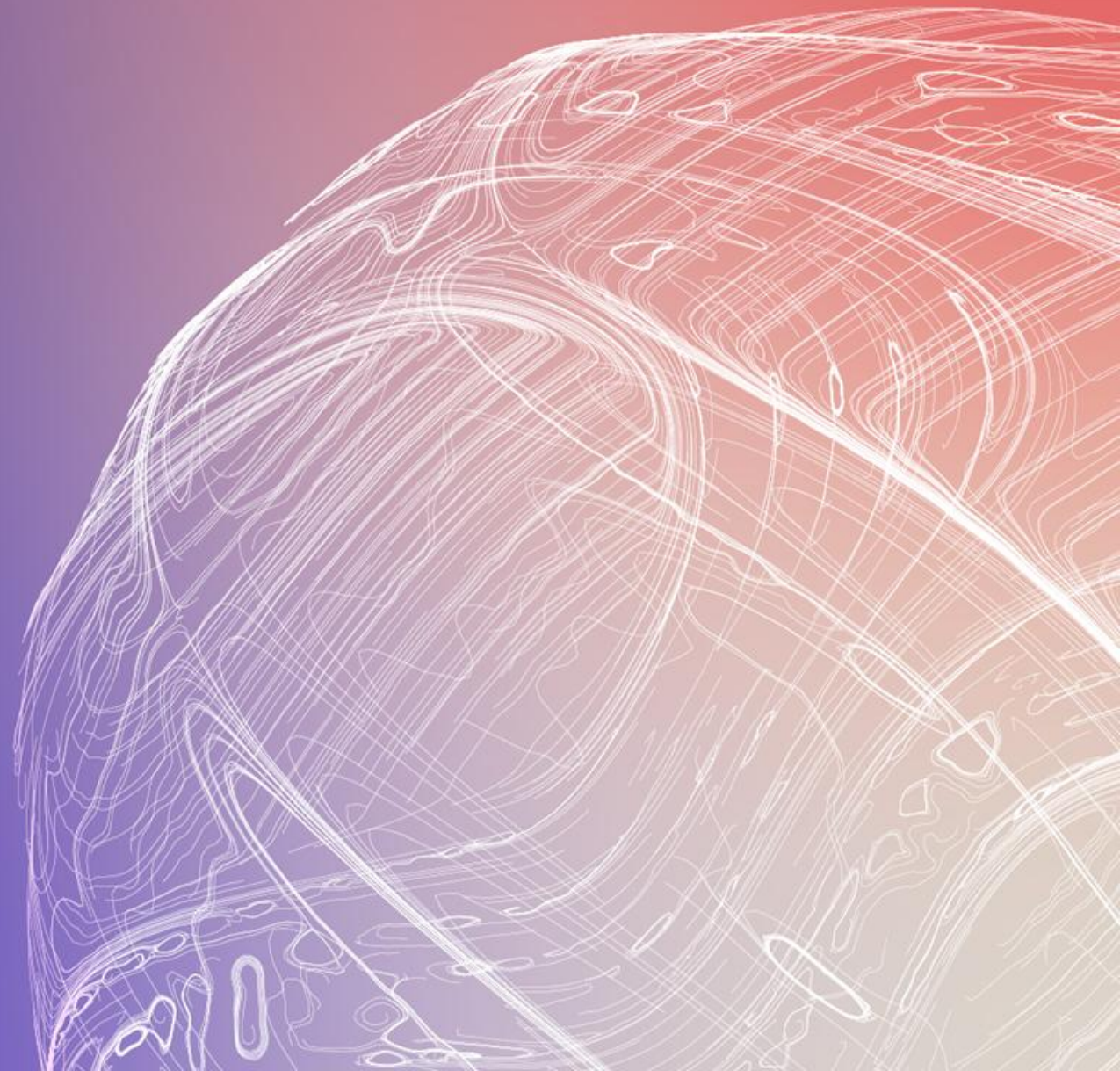
Supporting the transformation of ideas into implementable solutions more quickly.

Creating Impact

Contributing to improving and designing more efficient and effective government services that meet community needs.

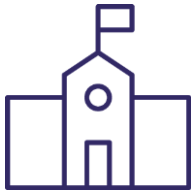
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UAE HACKATHON 2026 PARTICIPANTS



UAE Hackathon 2026 Participants

RISING STARS



- School Students
- 8 to 17 Years
- Focus on Ideas

PIONEERS



- University Students
- 18 to 25 Years
- Focus on Ideas & Prototypes

Track 2: Youth Hackathon

GOV INNOVATORS



- Federal and local government employees with innovative ideas
- Focus on creating policies and reports that support the elimination of bureaucracy.

STARTUPS



- Entrepreneurs
- Government employees with a desire to start startups
- Researchers interested in turning research into businesses

Track 1: Startups & Gov Innovators Hackathon

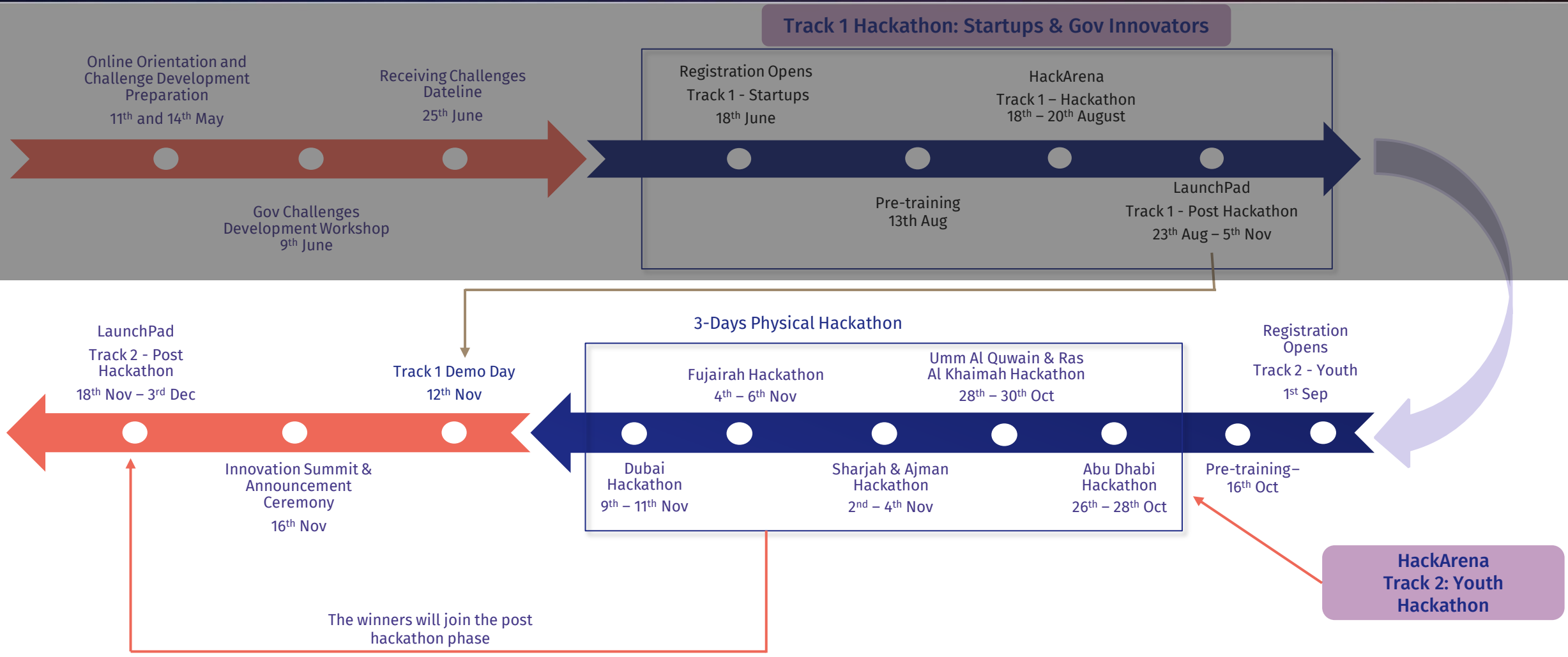
- Focus on High Quality Participants
- Engage mainly with Strategic Governmental Entities of a high commitment to adoption

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UAE HACKATHON 2026 JOURNEY



UAE Hackathon 2026 Journey



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UAE HACKATHON 2026 THEMES



UAE HACKATHON 2026 THEMES

Pillar 1: Human-Centric Inclusion

- **Theme 1: Family-Centric Digital Society**

This theme focuses on digital public services designed around family life events, ensuring that technology strengthens the family rather than disrupting it.

- **Theme 2: Inclusive Digital Accessibility & Empowered Communities**

This theme focuses on ensuring inclusive access to digital public services through accessibility-first design and innovative connectivity solutions that bridge geographic and socio-economic divides.

Pillar 2: Cognitive Government

- **Theme 3: Responsible AI & Smart Cognitive Government**

This theme focuses on deploying trustworthy AI to enhance government decision-making, planning, and policy development. It emphasizes the integration of AI with human expertise to enable smarter, data-driven governance.

Pillar 3: Trusted Digital Ecosystem

- **Theme 4: Digital Trust & Cyber-Secure Nation**

This theme focuses on strengthening trust in digital government services through robust cybersecurity, privacy protection, and resilient digital infrastructure.

Pillar 4: Seamless Public Services

- **Theme 5: Zero-Bureaucracy & Seamless Government**

This theme focuses on eliminating administrative complexity and transforming government service delivery into a seamless, integrated, and user-centric experience.

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UAE Hackathon
2026 Awards Scheme



Awards Scheme

	Startups	Rising Stars	Pioneers	Gov Innovators
1st	50,000	10,000	20,000	10,000
2nd	30,000	7,000	15,000	10,000
3rd	20,000	5,000	10,000	10,000
4th	15,000	3,000	5,000	-
5th	15,000	3,000	5,000	-
FROM 6th To 10th	15,000	3,000	5,000	-

- The Emerging Generation and Leading Generation & Entrepreneurs tracks will each have their top ten winners, while the Government Innovators track will have its top three winners.
- AED 10,000 of the prize money in the Entrepreneurs track will be allocated to each team to support prototype implementation during the post-hackathon phase.

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Thank You
for being part of our journey!

Registration

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UAE HACKATHON 2026 PARTICIPANT GUIDELINE

Official Step-by-Step Enrollment Guide Portal Manual

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Complete your Registration



Step 1

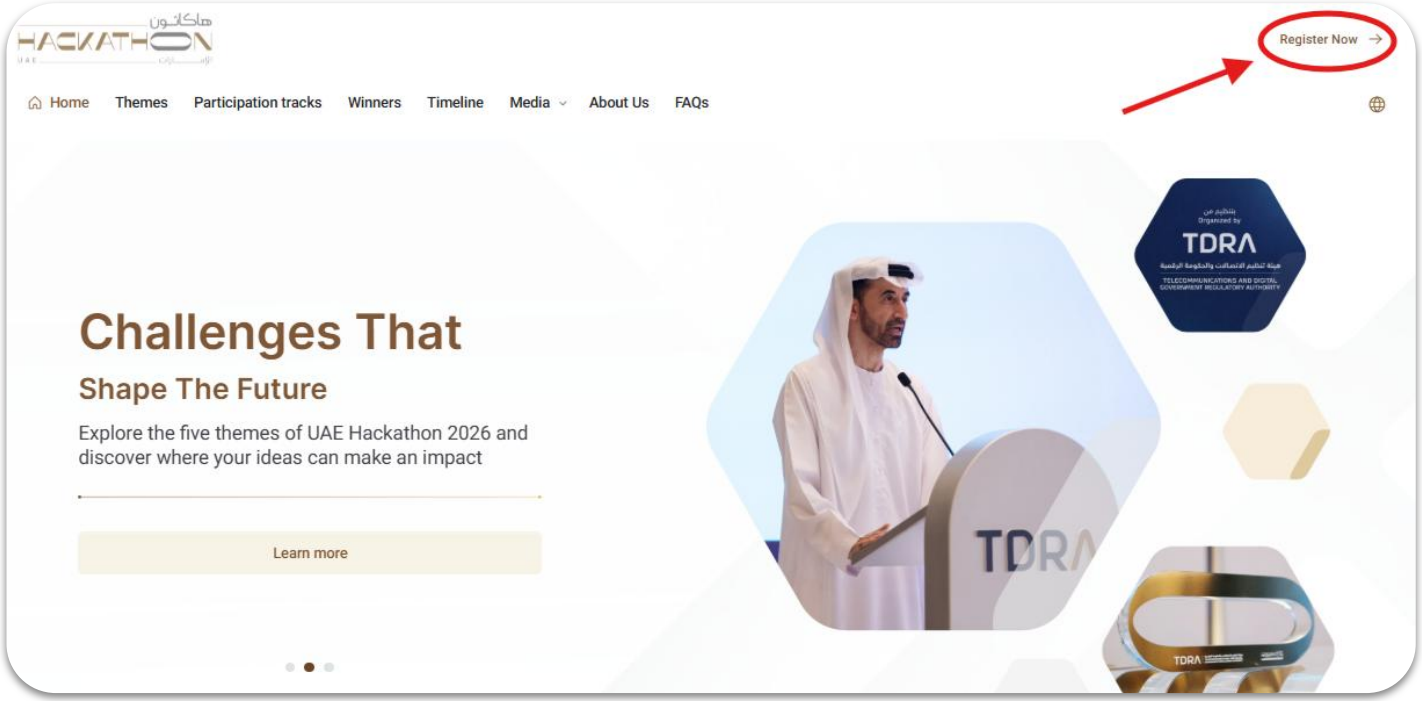
Access the UAE Hackathon Portal

Action Required

Launch your preferred internet browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge, or Firefox) and navigate to the official platform url: **hackathon.ae.**

Navigation

Locate the central prominent banner showcasing the text 'Empowering Digital Societies Summit'. Look at the bottom right quadrant of this graphic section and click or tap the bronze-colored **Register Now** button.



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

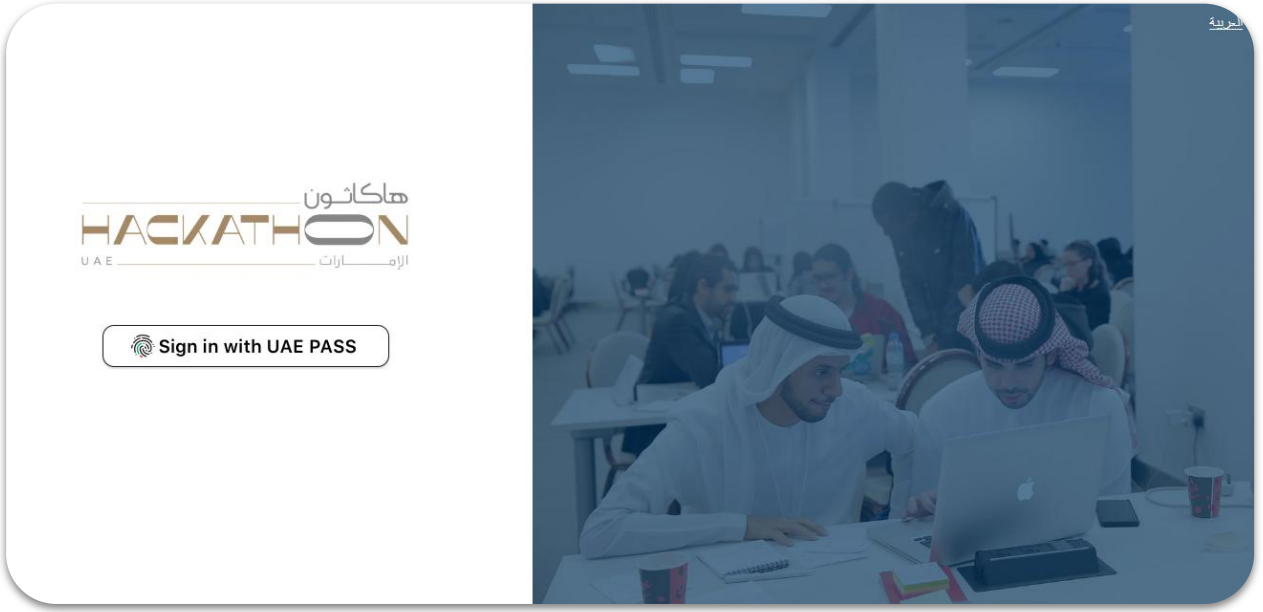
The entire web application is built with a mobile-first responsive layout. If registering via smartphone, the 'Register Now' button dynamically adapts to sit centered within your screen view for seamless tap accessibility.

Step 2

Authentication via UAE PASS

Action Required

Upon clicking the registration option, the application redirects you to a secure login gateway. Click the centered white button labeled **Sign in with UAE PASS.**



Verification

Provide your official UAE PASS identifier (associated Mobile Number, Email, or Emirates ID). Once entered, open the **UAE PASS Mobile App** on your personal device and authorize the verification request immediately using your secure biometric pin.

PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

Ensure your UAE PASS application is fully configured, validated, and updated to the latest store build before beginning. This circumvents prospective security token handshaking timeouts.

Step 3

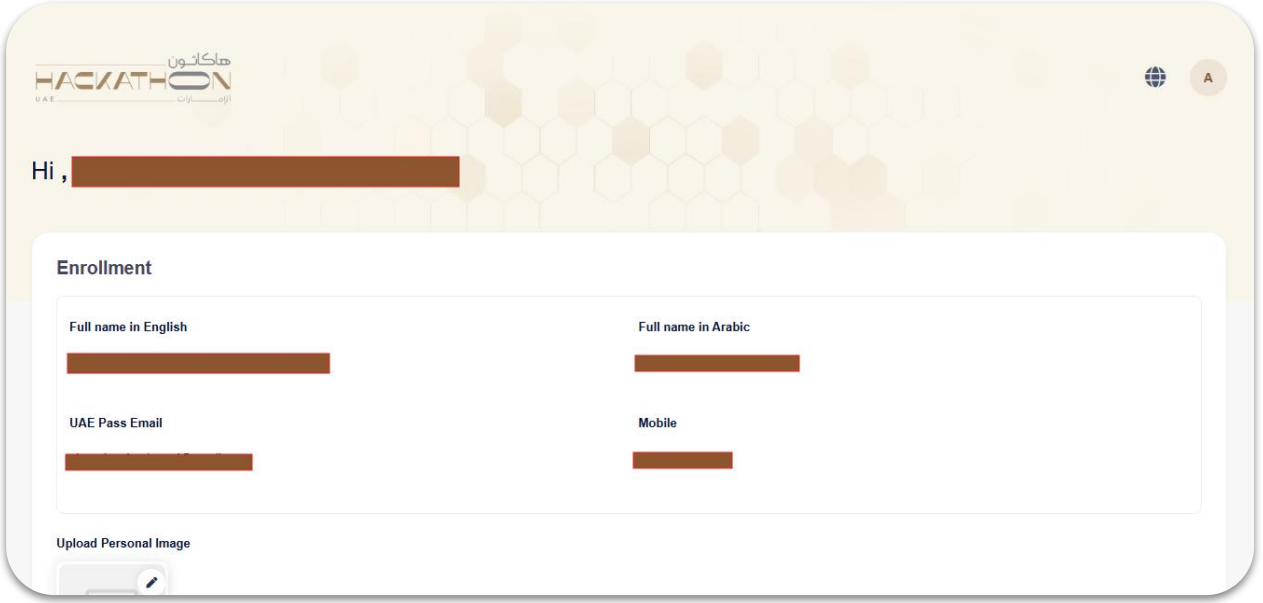
Data Confirmation & Profile Setup

Action Required

Following a successful UAE PASS identity verification, you will be redirected back to the hackathon enrollment wizard. Carefully review the automatically populated read-only core identification text fields under the **Enrollment** section: Full Name in English, Full Name in Arabic, UAE Pass Email, and Mobile Number.

Profile Modification

Look right below the identity layout panel to locate the **Upload Personal Image** module. Click or tap the small circular edit/pencil icon sitting on the placeholder boundary to load and upload a clear, high-resolution professional portrait picture.



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

Because these specific information fields are securely synchronized against standard federal registries via UAE PASS, they are locked to prevent arbitrary manual edits. If any vital contact element is incorrect, update it directly inside your official UAE PASS settings first.

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Step 4

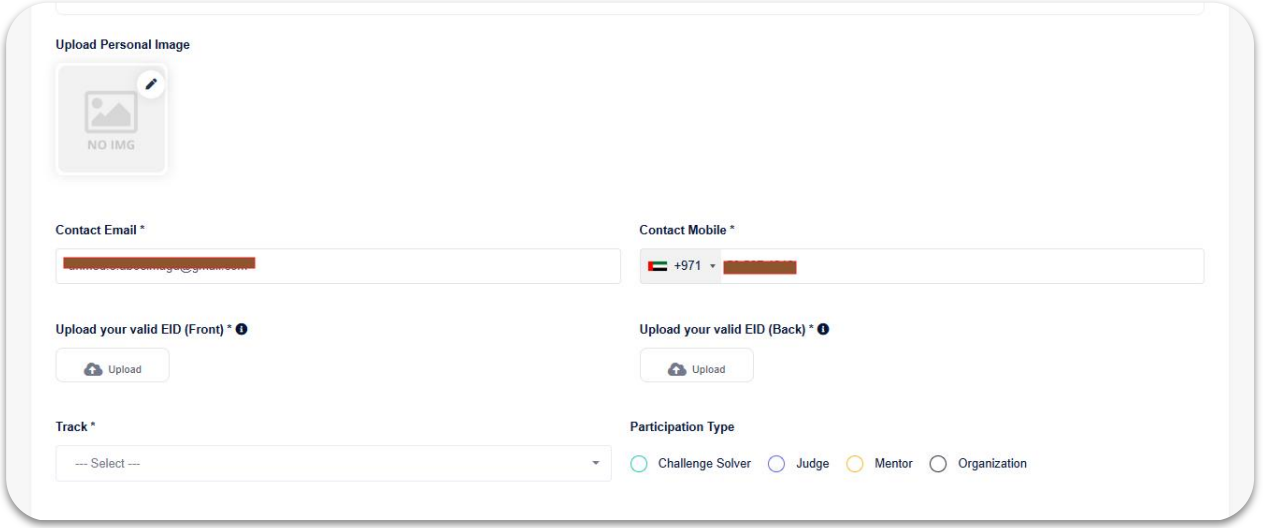
Contact Details & Identity Verification

Action Required

Input your preferred **Contact Email** and **Contact Mobile** details manually into the provided form elements. Double-check that your international country flag selector is correctly configured to the United Arab Emirates (+971).

Document Upload

Locate the identity document upload controls. Click the corresponding **Upload** icons individually to supply valid, high-fidelity graphic scans of your **Emirates ID (Front)** followed by your **Emirates ID (Back).**



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

Every text box or element containing a red asterisk symbol (*) indicates a strictly mandatory parameter. Please supply high-quality images or clear electronic document formats (PNG, JPEG) to guarantee verification approval by review committees.

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Step 5

Choosing Your Category & Track

This represents a critical foundational architecture phase of your registration.

Each applicant must pick a specific participation profile type accompanied by their corresponding operational track classification.

Track Name / Classification	Target Strategic Audience Description
Pioneers	Allocated specifically to current academic University, College, and Higher Education institution students.
Rising Stars	Designed tailored for younger generational innovators, including primary and secondary K-12 school students.
Gov Innovators	Reserved exclusively for public sector professionals, corporate ministerial stakeholders, and local/federal government entity employees.

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Step 5

Choosing Your Category & Track

Detailed Participation Roles

Challenge Solver

The default strategic selection tier designed for general platform competitors. Select this if you are actively intending to compete, join or construct a team, write code, build project mockups, and pitch solutions to the panels.

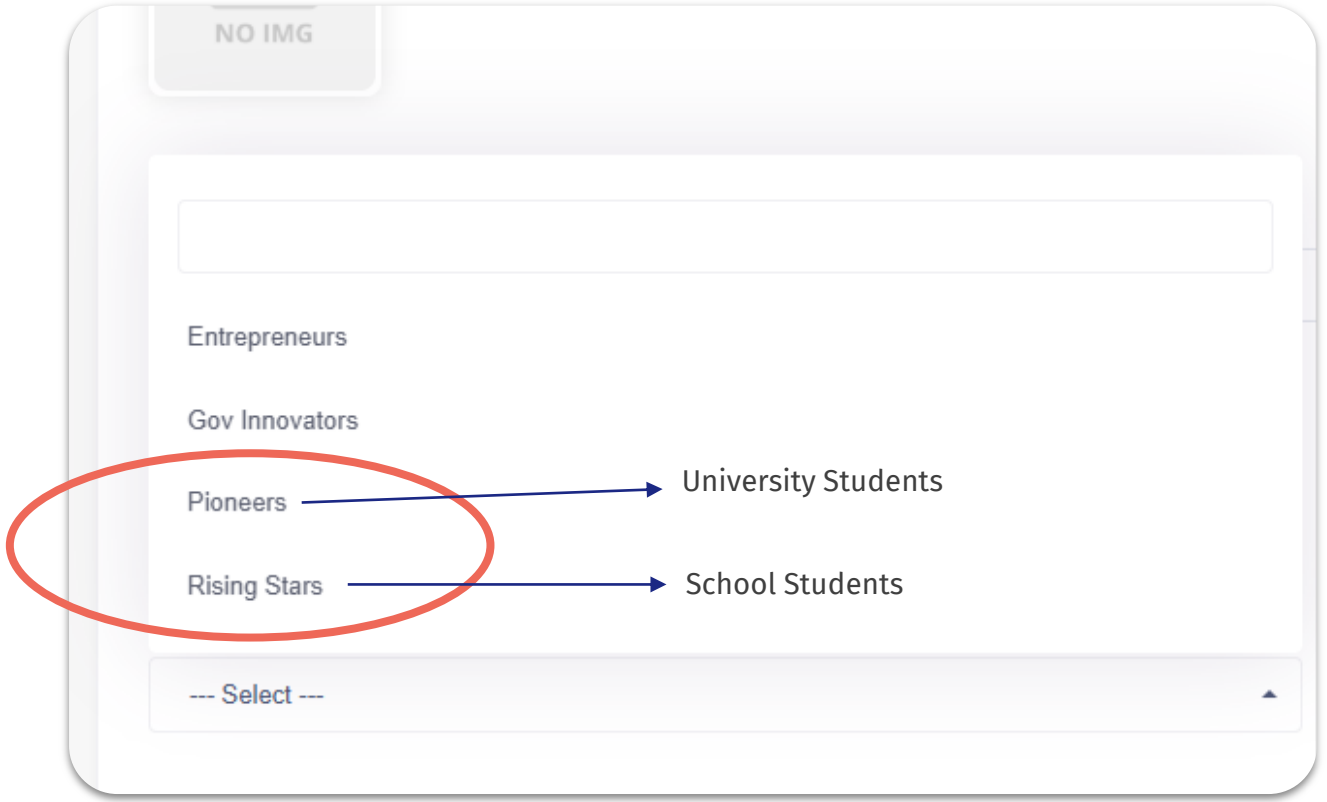
Judges

Reserved for veteran industry subject matter experts, academics, and strategic technologists tasked with evaluating hackathon submissions.

NOTE: Selecting this triggers an intensive, manual vetting review protocol by the official hackathon management committee for approval.

Mentor

Dedicated to experienced business leaders, coaches, or engineering specialists aiming to offer guidance and technical advisory support to active teams. **NOTE: Profiles under this tier require separate review and validation by organizers before activation.**



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Step 6

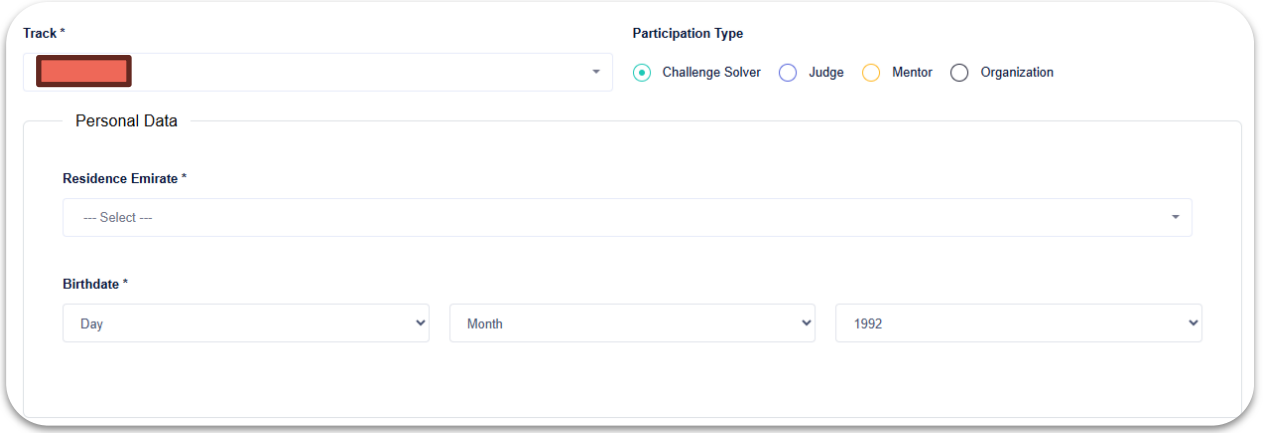
Complete Your Personal Data

Action Required

Move down the customized profile wizard interface to fill out remaining secondary biographical fields. Select your specific local emirate of habitation via the **Residence Emirate** dropdown element (such as Abu Dhabi, Dubai, Sharjah, Ajman, Umm Al Quwain, Ras Al Khaimah, or Fujairah).

Demographics

Input your chronological Date of Birth accurately using the structured individual select fields: **Day, Month, and Year.**



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

The database layout engine alters form fields contextually according to your selected Category/Track selection.
It checks demographic ranges programmatically to prevent mismatched team classification entries (e.g., age bracket cross-checks for school-level tracks).

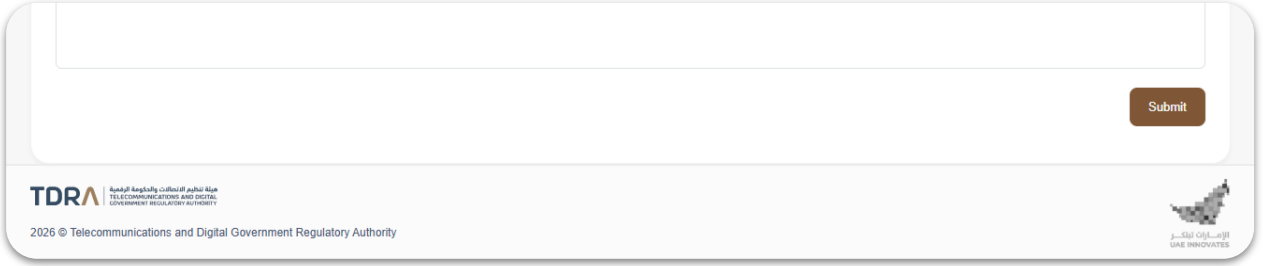
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Step 7

Final Data Submission

Action Required

Perform a comprehensive visual sweep and alignment check across all fields to confirm compliance. Scroll down to the final bottom edge of the container panel, locate the bronze-colored **Submit** button, and click it firmly to complete your profile dispatch.



Next Steps

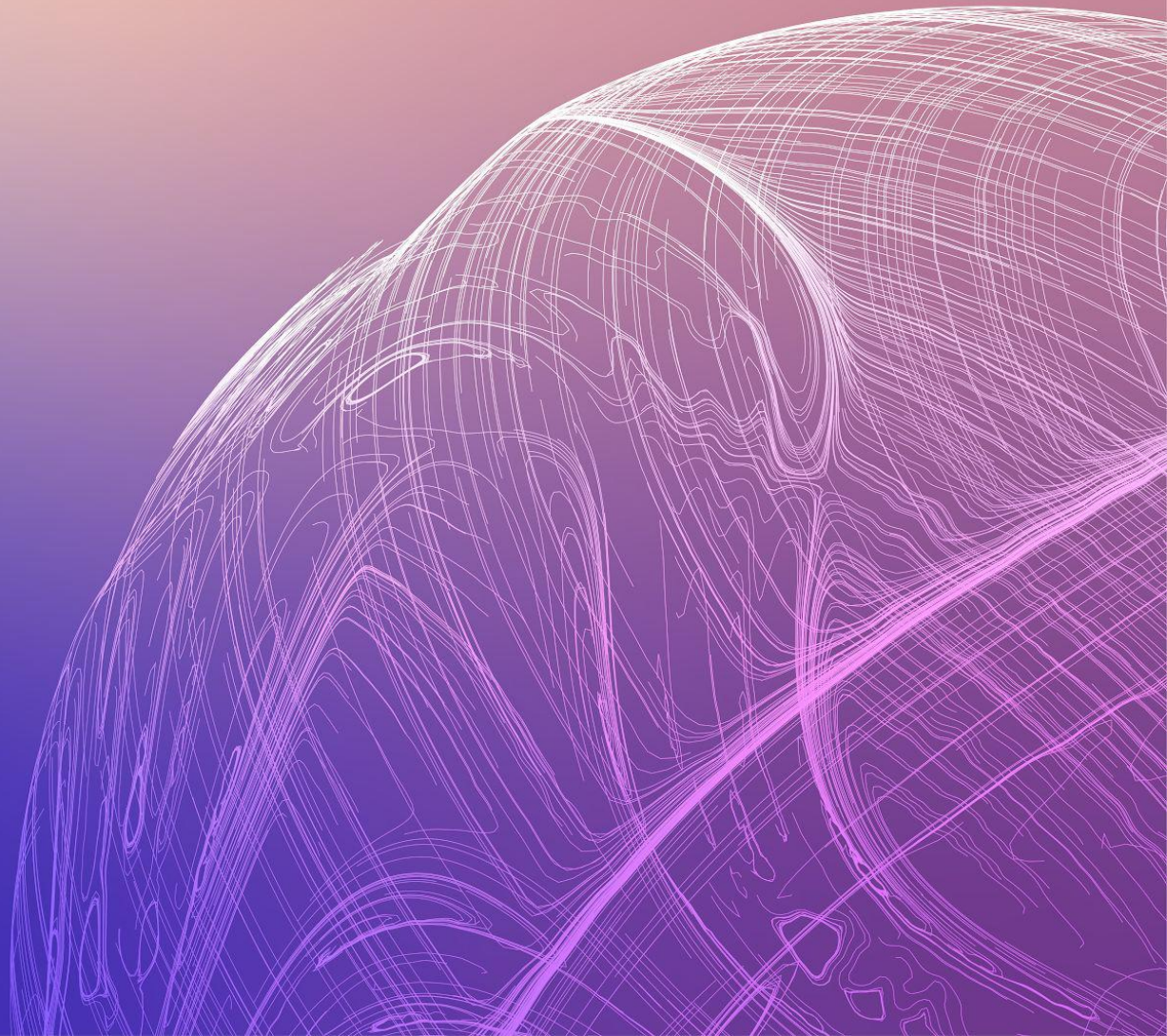
Upon submission, the platform routes your profile parameters into the database. A verification alert notification will be sent immediately to your designated Contact Email address containing subsequent directions for project grouping stages.

PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

After clicking Submit, do not close or refresh your browser window until a green success modal confirmation appears.
Keep a regular check on your junk/spam email box folders for communication messages or automated credentials sent by the portal team.

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Team Creation Guide



Step 1

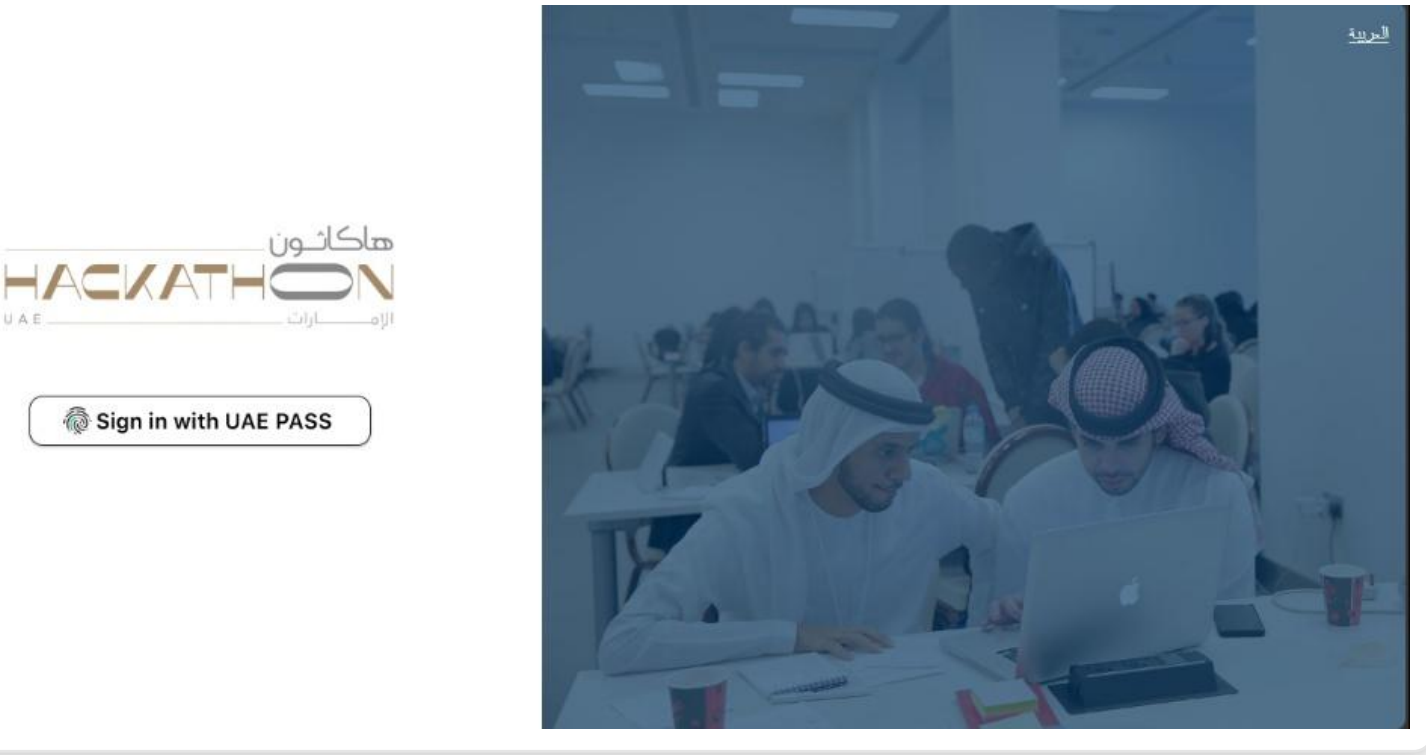
Account Login via UAE PASS

Action Required

Visit the official portal at hackathon.ae and locate the sign-in screen for the UAE Hackathon platform.

Verification

Click the “Sign in with UAE PASS” button, then approve the authentication request on your mobile device using the UAE PASS application.



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

Make sure your UAE PASS app is installed, updated, and linked to your mobile number or Emirates ID before you begin.

Step 2

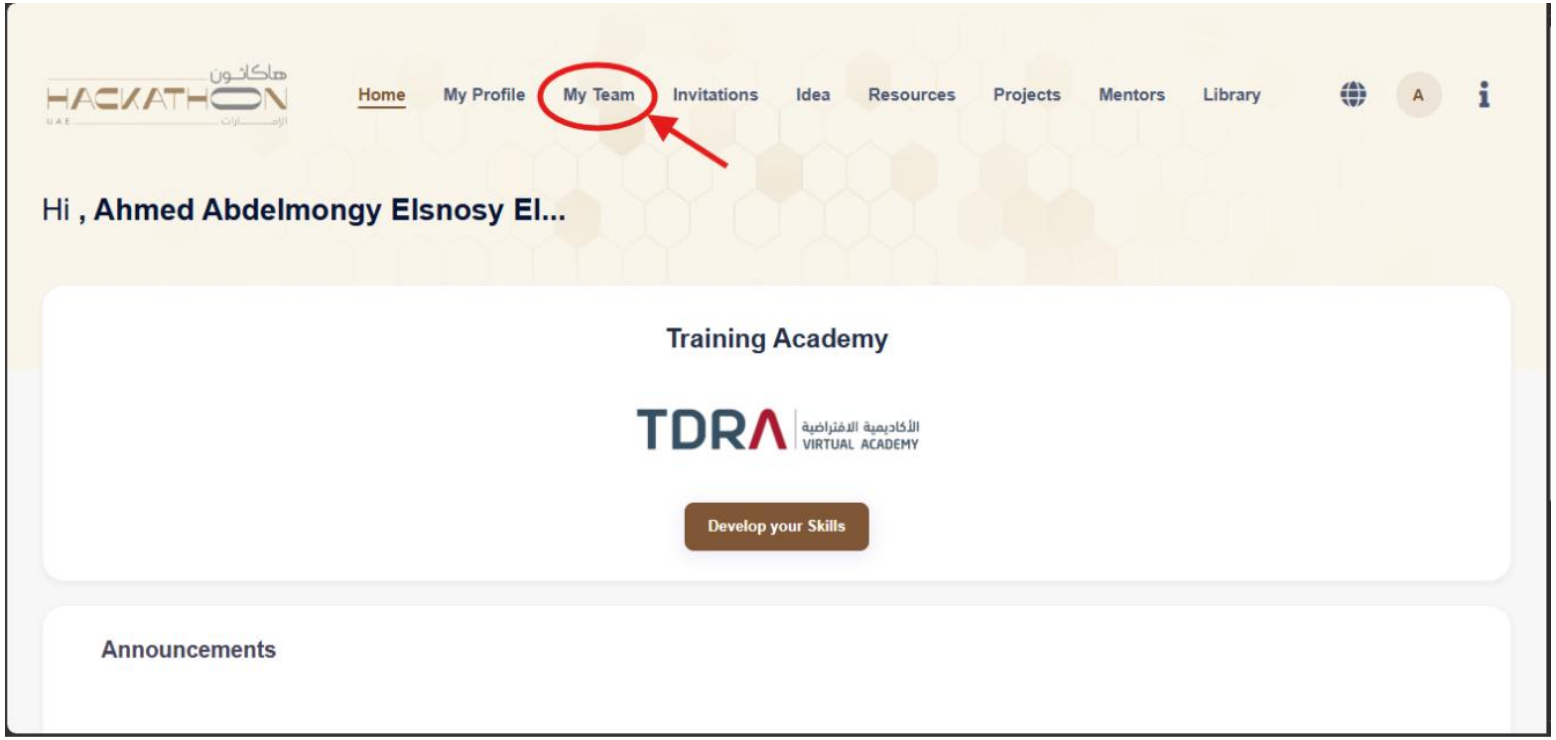
Navigate to “My Team”

Action Required

After logging in, locate the main navigation menu at the top of your dashboard.

Navigation

Click on “My Team,” positioned between My Profile and Invitations, to open your team overview.



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

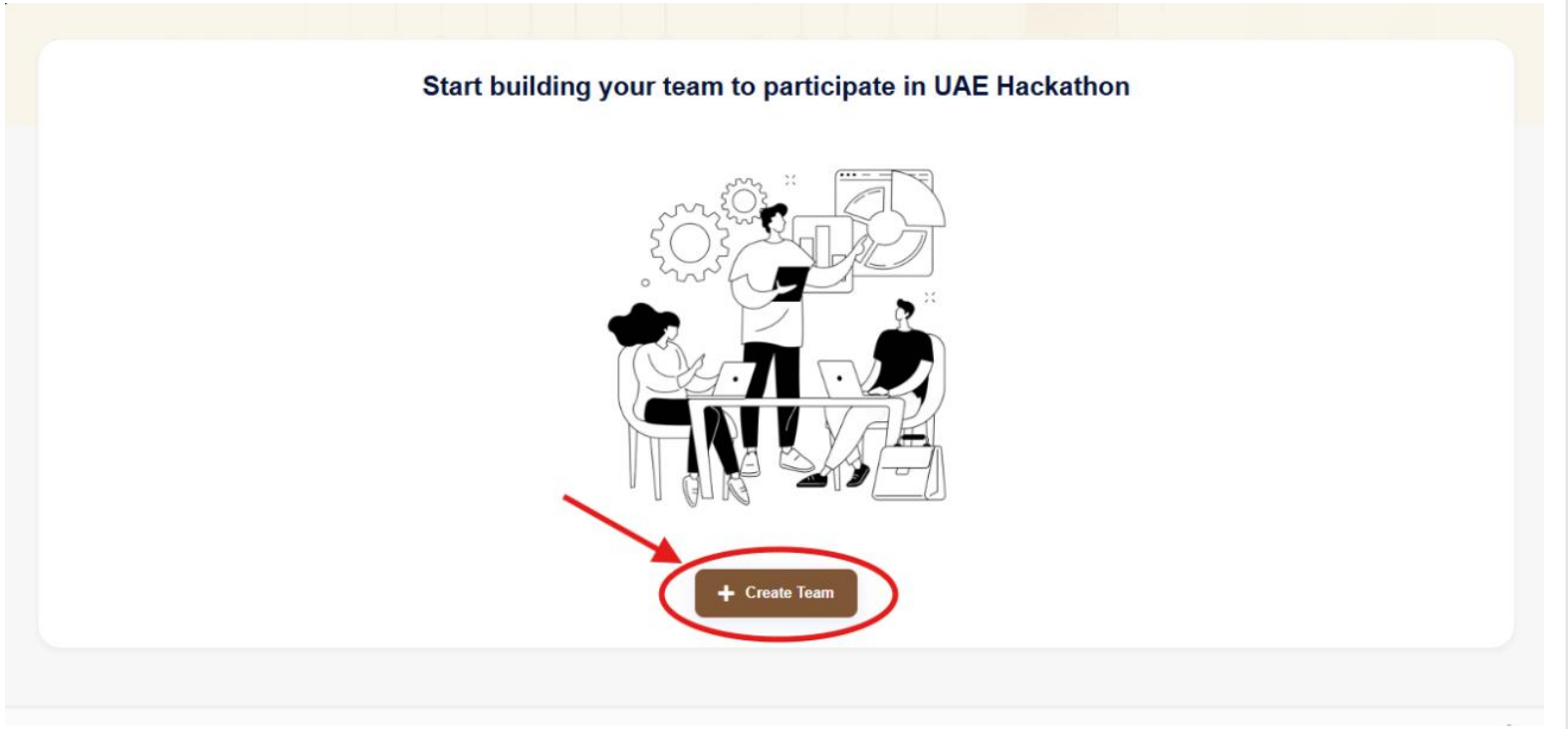
Your top navigation bar also gives quick access to Idea, Resources, Projects, Mentors, and Library sections.

Step 3

Initiate Team Creation

Action Required

On the team overview card, click the brown “+ Create Team” button at the bottom center to open the team registration form.



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

You can only be a member of one team per hackathon track, so confirm your track choice before creating a team.

Step 4

Hackathon & Track Selection

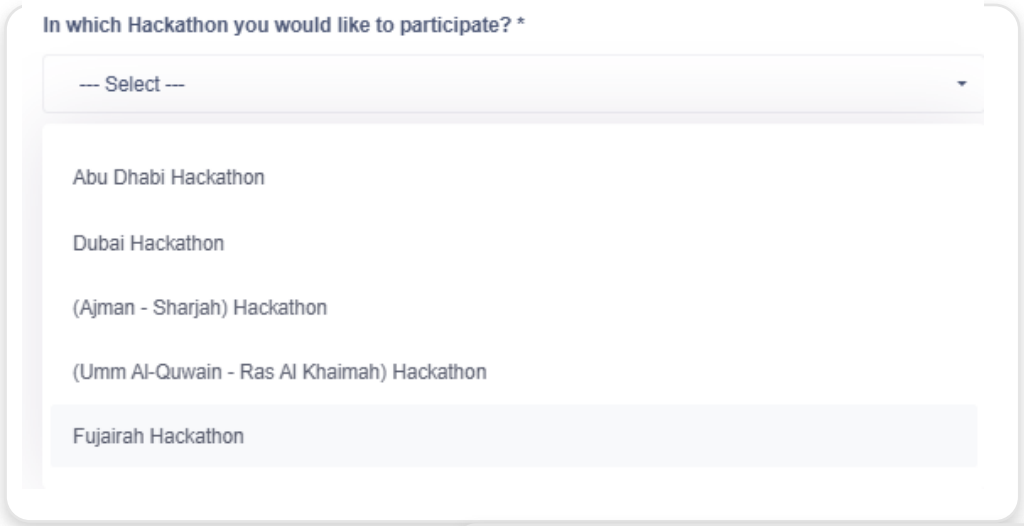
Hackathon

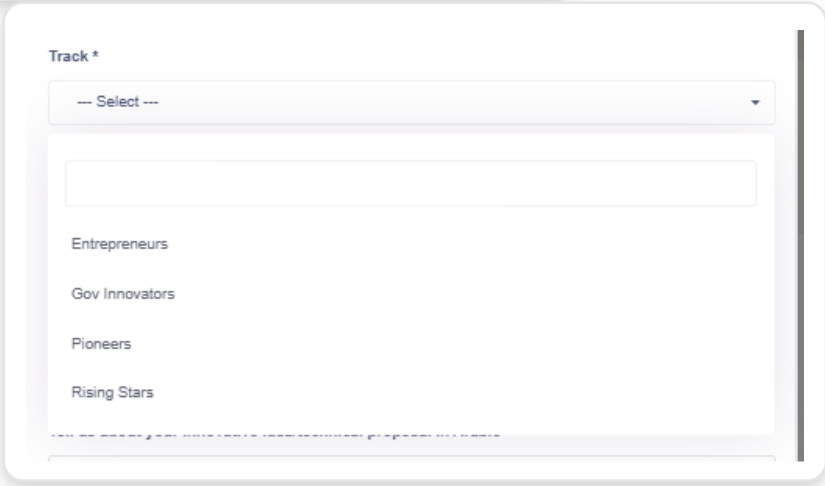
Select which hackathon you would like to participate in (Required): choose one location from the list of the hackathon location.

- Abu Dhabi Hackathon
- Ajman & Sharjah Hackathon
- Umm Al Quwain & Ras Al Khaimah Hackathon
- Fujairah Hackathon
- Dubai Hackathon

Track

Choose Pioneer for University Students, or Rising Stas for the School Students. Ignore “Entrepreneurs ” and “Gov Innovators” .





PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

Both fields are required — your hackathon and track selections determine which theme and challenge options appear next.

Step 4

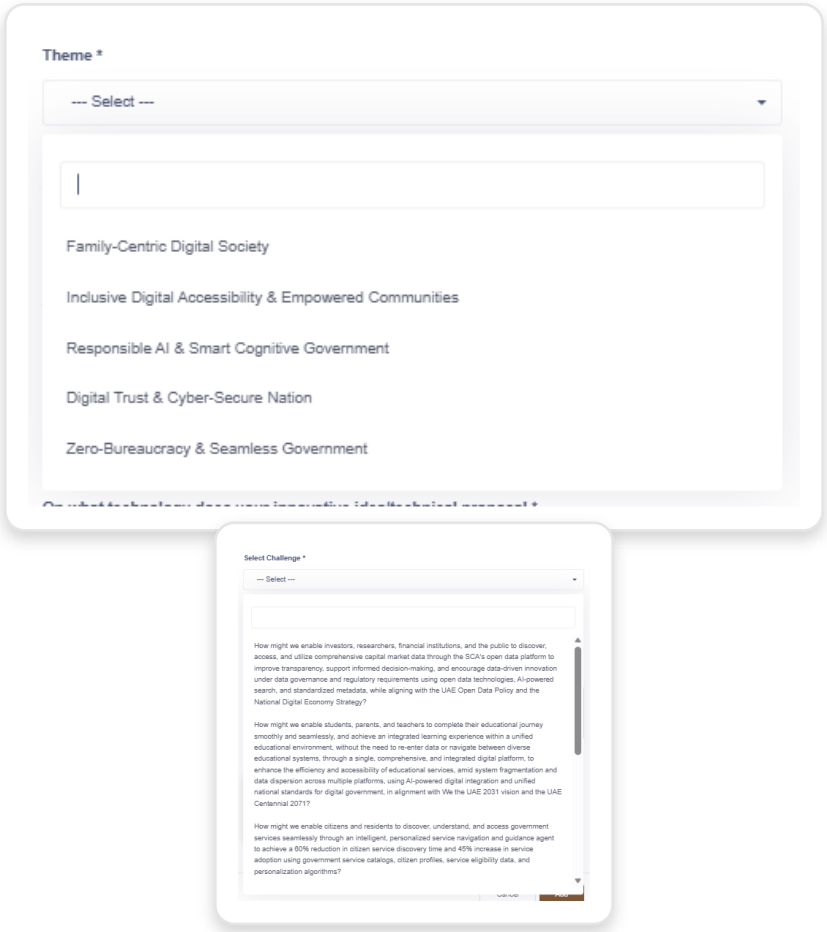
Theme & Challenge Selection

Theme

Select the topic area aligned with your initiative (Required): Family-Centric Digital Society, Inclusive Digital Accessibility & Empowered Communities, Responsible AI & Smart Cognitive Government, Digital Trust & Cyber-Secure Nation, or Zero-Bureaucracy & Seamless Government.

Challenge

Choose the specific challenge statement your team will solve from the dropdown menu that appears after selecting a theme (Required).



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

Read each challenge statement carefully — your team's proposal in the next step should directly address it.

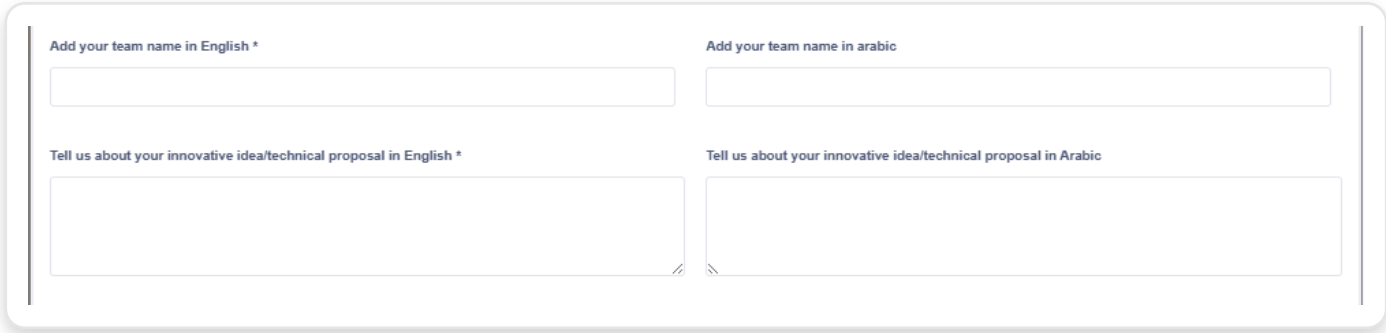
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Step 4

Team Name, Proposal, Technology & Photo

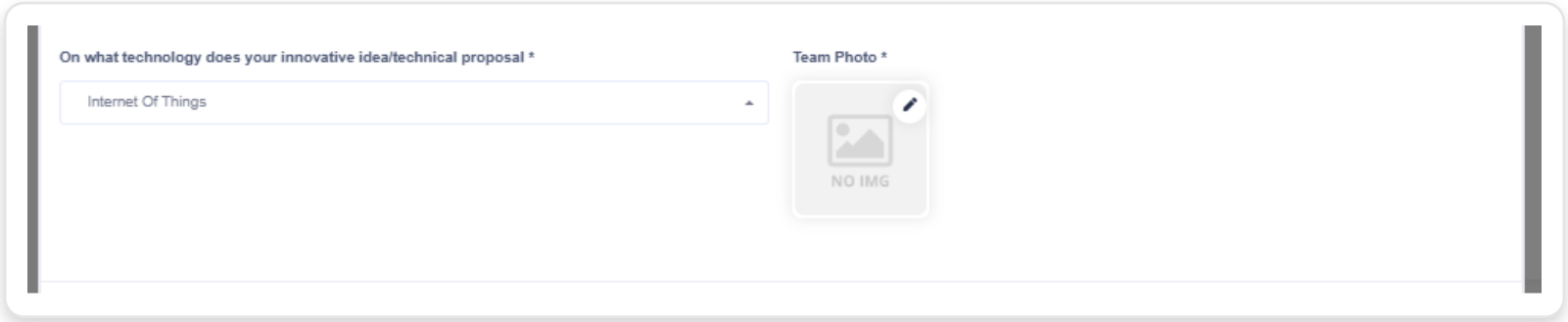
Team Name

Add your team name in English (Required) and, optionally, in Arabic. Then describe your innovative idea / technical proposal in English (Required) and, optionally, in Arabic — covering your project description, functionality, and unique value.



Tech & Photo

Select the core technology your solution relies on (e.g. IoT, Artificial Intelligence) from the dropdown (Required). Click the pencil icon on the placeholder box to upload your Team Photo or project logo (Required).



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

Keep your proposal concise and specific — judges see this description before your live pitch.

Step 5

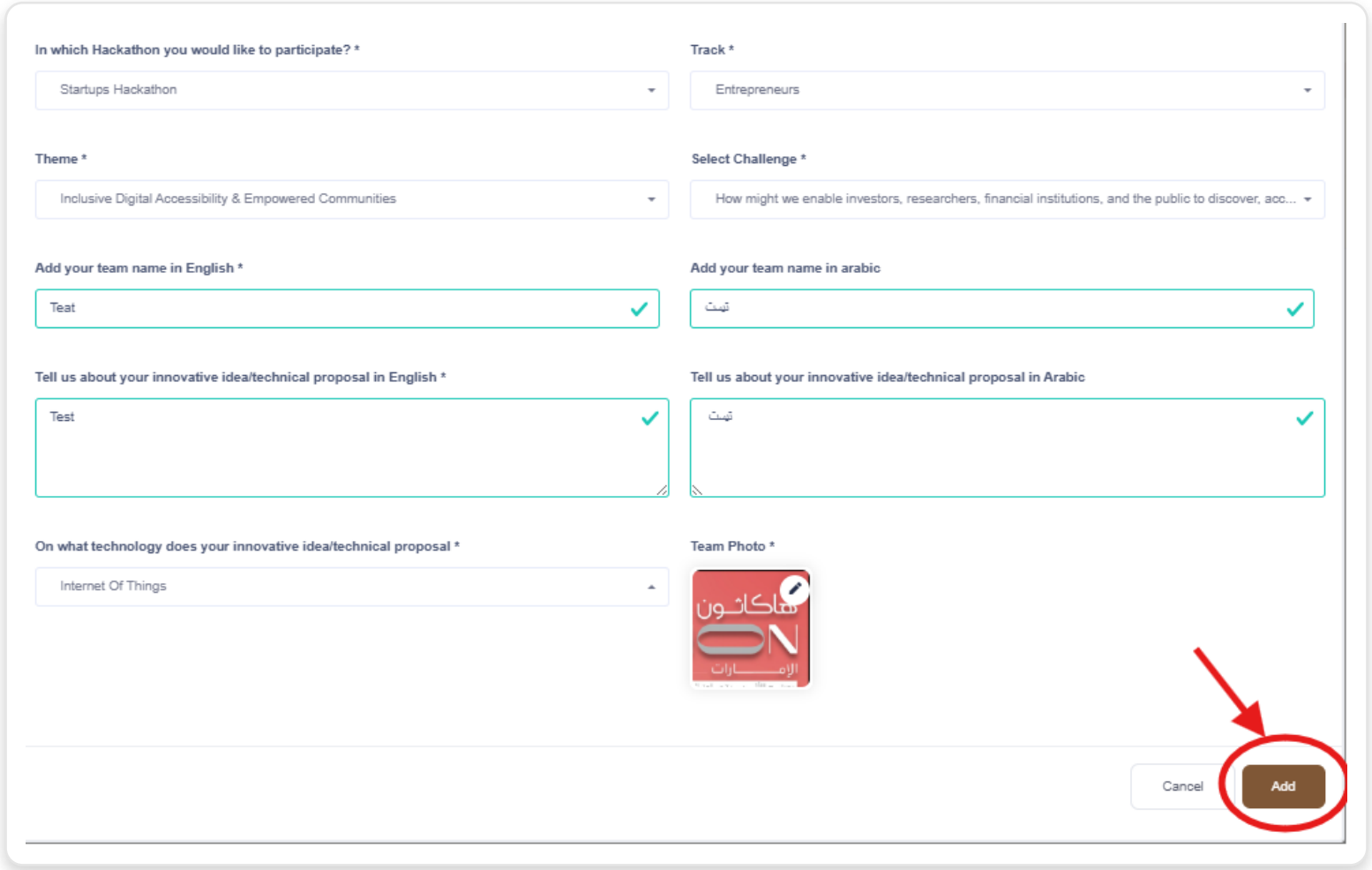
Submit Team Creation

Review

Verify that every mandatory field displays a green checkmark before submitting.

Submit

Click the brown “Add” button at the bottom-right corner of the form to submit and create your team.



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

Double-check spelling of your team name and proposal text — these fields may be locked once your team is approved.

Step 6

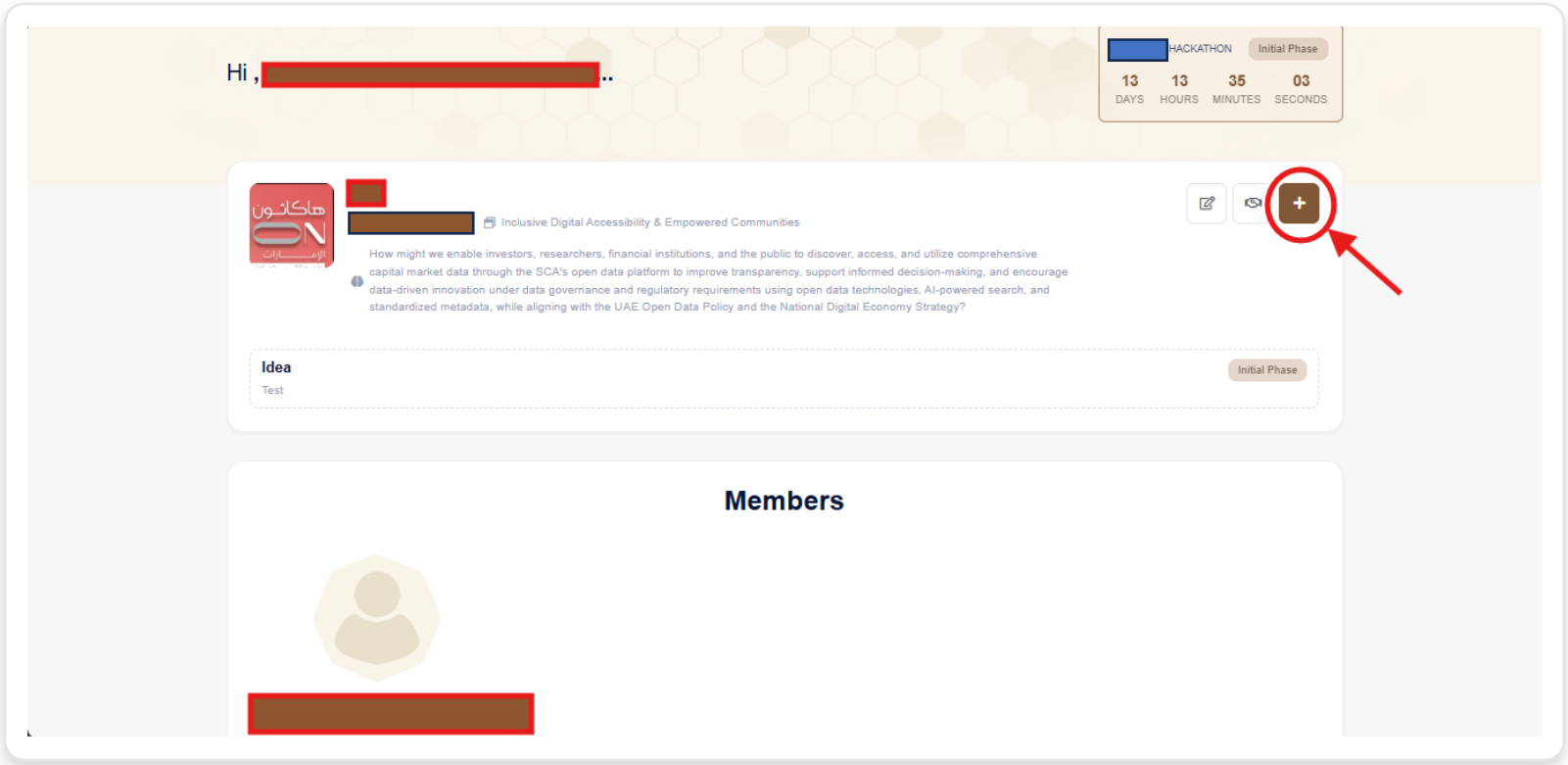
Team Dashboard & Management Actions

Overview

Upon submission you are directed to your Team Dashboard: track the active phase and remaining time via the countdown timer, and review your team logo, hackathon category, theme, challenge statement, and idea description.

Manage

Use the pencil icon to edit your team or project details, the handshake icon to contact your assigned mentor, and the brown circular “+” icon to invite team members. The Members section lists everyone on your team.



PRO-TIP / IMPORTANT NOTE

Your teammates must register individually before sending them the invitation.
When you invite your teammate, you should enter the his\her registered email om UAE Hackathon portal.

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Thank You ..

